

What Should I Do?

Rahab Harris glanced at her clock. 8:30

She paced her room, her thoughts in a whirl. Memories of that afternoon came flooding back.

Rahab walked out of school with her friend, Sophie Miller.

"It's not like you need to follow your parents, right?" Sophie had asked, "They don't want to 'force you into your faith.' Unless, you do believe in that...stuff."

"Well.." Rahab hesitated.

"Anyways, the others are planning to hang out tonight, wanna join?"

"You know I can't."

"Sneak out."

"I can't do that!"

Sophie's smirk settled into a scowl, "So, you think you're so good you can't hang out-"

"You know I don't." Rahab said softly.

"You sure?" Sophie smiled slyly, holding out a packet of cigarettes in her hand, "Prove it, and I won't call you a goody-goody again. Hey, I might even go to your church next week."

Rahab hesitated, "I don't think I'm too good for you or anyone else, Sophie. I just don't smoke."

"Pity. I guess I can't go to your church then? Am I too bad to go there?"

"Sophie, I don't-"

"Fine." Sophie smiled slyly. "If you mean it, meet us tonight. 8:45. The usual place."

And with that, Sophie turned on her heel and left.

Rahab paused. She picked up a picture of Sophie and herself. They were so happy... at least, when they first met. But, ever since Sophie had started to hang out with a certain group of

friends, she...changed. A lot. Rahab had become slightly uncomfortable whenever they hung out together.

The only reason Rahab stays with Sophie is to share the Gospel with her(as she often told herself). But now, she isn't so sure about that.

Rahab sat up as a sudden thought slipped in, quiet but dangerous.

God did this.

Her face contorted in anger. Of course it is.

Rahab silently packed her bag, her heart hammering.

Soon Rahab could hear the snorings and mutterings of her sleeping family. It's time to go.

She slipped out through the window, straining her ears for any sign of movement. Nothing. Her heart beat fast as she closed the window softly. Silencing the voices in her head, she turned and ran.

Rahab thought hard. What does Sophie mean by "the usual place?" Maybe Sophie's house? Rahab remembered stopping by once several months ago, though she wasn't allowed in.

Sea Cliff, that was Sophie's neighborhood, Rahab thought. Her house was the only white one.

She took a bus to Sea Cliff, then walked silently through the streets. She stopped at No. 298, the only white one she could see.

Shouts were heard distinctly inside, with the occasional slap echoing across the house.

Rahab's heart beat unpleasantly fast as she knocked the door.

The silence that followed was louder than any shout.

A tall man opened the door. Rahab stepped back. His eyes were slightly bloodshot and he swayed slightly.

"What do you want?"

Rahab could tell she was *not* welcome. Her instincts were screaming for her to run back home. She took a deep breath and forced herself to speak.

"Erm, is Sophie here?" Inwardly, she was hoping this was *not* Sophie's house.

"Sophie?" he growled. "She's away."

Rahab's phone sounded. With a twinge of horror, she saw several missed calls from her parents, and... a message from Sophie.

We've been waiting fifteen minutes. Where are you?

With trembling fingers, she texted back.

At your house. Number 298.

No reply. Rahab's heart dropped.

It wasn't long before Sophie was running up to her, looking angrier than Rahab had ever seen her.

"What do you think you're doing?" Sophie said through gritted teeth.

"Oh, this is dumb." The man muttered and shut the door.

Rahab saw behind Sophie, Katherine, a girl usually seen smoking out of school and two other boys.

"The usual place. The cafe near school! Why would it be here?" Sophie demanded.

"I-I don't-I never went out with you and the others." Rahab stammered. "I met your dad-"

"Get out! Get out of my sight!" Sophie shouted. Katherine sneered as the two boys laughed mockingly.

Rahab had never seen Sophie this mad. Only one thing was in her mind now: run.

So she did.

Thunder rumbled in the distance. Rain started to pour. Rahab kept running, tears streaming down her face as she looked desperately for somewhere to shelter.

It wasn't long before a bus stop gleamed a few feet away. People stared as Rahab stumbled in, gasping.

Rahab stood, shaking, trying to pull herself together. The rain faded to a faint buzzing in her ears as she closed her eyes. She certainly didn't expect this.

Where did this all go wrong?

Sophie's house...Rahab never knew. Sophie never talked about her parents. Sure, Rahab had asked to meet there a couple of times, but Sophie always insisted on meeting somewhere else.

What should she do now? Should she make up with Sophie? What if she went home? Would her parents be mad?

"Excuse me, young lady, are you alright? You're shaking." A middle-aged woman said kindly.

Rahab jumped, wiping her eyes, "Oh-yes, I-I'm okay."

The woman nodded and looked at the bus timetable. Rahab looked too.

If she returned to Sea Cliff, would Sophie forgive her?

But...

Richmond: 10:00 p.m

Back home. She checked her watch. 9:30 p.m.

The Presidio: 9:45 p.m

Where was that? What if she ran away even further?

She buried her face in her hands.

This is all Sophie's fault, she thought angrily, then faltered. But I should have texted her, maybe...

She always seemed so confident, easygoing, and kind...

Well, she's not a bad person, Rahab thought firmly. Just a person with a hard life. And the wrong friends.

What can I do?

Then, as if it was whispered in her ear, a verse slipped into her mind. The verse that hung beside her bed. The verse she unintentionally memorized.

Do not be anxious about anything, but in every situation, by prayer and petition, present your requests to God.

And the peace of God, which transcends all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus.

She sat down, bowed her head and closed her eyes.

Lord, it's me, Rahab. I guess I haven't been the best Christian. Or friend. But You are. You're always there for me, and I really need you now. I don't know what to do. I've made a mistake and I want to make it right. But how? Please give me a sign Lord. I can't do this without You. I realize that now. Your will be done. Amen.

Rahab opened her eyes. She shivered slightly in her wet clothing, but she felt a certain peace inside her.

A bus rolled in. She checked her watch. 9:45.

Rahab stayed seated.

10:00 came. Another bus rolled in. Richmond District. Home.

Rahab stepped on, scared, but she knows God is with her. She slid in some money, then took her seat.

By the time she got home, the rain had stopped.

She walked to her house and with a trembling hand, rang the doorbell. She could hear frantic whispers as she stood nervously on the doorstep.

Silence. Hurried footsteps. The door opened, revealing three faces staring in disbelief.

Rahab's teary-faced mother spoke first.

"What happened? You weren't answering our calls! Where have you been?"

Rahab tried to say something, but no sound came out. Tears started to form in her eyes.

Her mother looked concerned, "Come inside, dear. Tell us what happened." Rahab nodded, her throat dry, and went inside. Her parents and sister followed.

"You'd better have a good explanation for this, young lady." Rahab's father added, his voice radiating relief despite himself.

With her family around her, Rahab started explaining everything: the dare Sophie gave her, how Sophie had kept her family a secret for so long, and finally, how she came back to God.

"And, I'm sorry. Really sorry. I should've told you this before, and I shouldn't have run away--"

"Dear, we're just glad you're safe." Rahab's mother said. "It must have been difficult to come back, but you did."

"I want Sophie to accept the Lord, but I can't tell her to have a relationship with someone I've been ignoring." Rahab gave a weak smile. "I couldn't have done it without God."

"If you'd like, we can visit Sophie and her parents tomorrow." Rahab's father offered.

Rahab hesitated.

"That would be nice." She finally said.

"Good. Now, go get some sleep."

Rahab nodded and went to her room. She sat down and closed her eyes.

Hey, God, it's me again.

Thanks a lot for showing me where to go. I wasn't sure then, but I'm glad I came back.

Please help me tomorrow at Sophie's house. Show me the right thing to say, and please soften Sophie's heart.

Your will be done. Amen.

Rahab opened her eyes and smiled.

Whatever happens tomorrow, she knows she isn't alone.